

Backtick strings that support embedded expressions, multi-line text, and cleaner string composition — a massive upgrade over traditional string concatenation.

The Problem Template Literals Solve

Before template literals, building dynamic strings required painful concatenation with `+`:

```
const name = "mona";
const age = 30;

// Old way - hard to read, easy to make mistakes
console.log('My name is ' + name + ' and I am ' + age + ' years old');
// "My name is mona and I am 30 years old"

// Template literal - clean and readable
console.log(`My name is ${name} and I am ${age} years old`);
// "My name is mona and I am 30 years old"
```

Syntax: Use backticks ``` instead of single `'` or double `"` quotes.

Feature 1 — String Interpolation `${}`

Embed any JavaScript expression directly inside a string using `${}`:

```
const name = "mona";
const age = 30;

// Variable
console.log(`Hello, ${name}!`); // "Hello, mona!"

// Expression
console.log(`In 5 years, she will be ${age + 5}`); // "In 5 years,
```

```
she will be 35"
```

```
// Function call
```

```
console.log(`Name uppercase: ${name.toUpperCase()}`); // "Name  
uppercase: MONA"
```

```
// Ternary operator
```

```
const isAdult = age >= 18;  
console.log(`Status: ${isAdult ? "adult" : "minor"}`); // "Status:  
adult"
```

```
// Math
```

```
console.log(`Pi approx: ${((22/7).toFixed(4))}`); // "Pi approx:  
3.1429"
```

Anything inside `${}` is evaluated as JavaScript — variables, math, function calls, ternaries, even other template literals. The result is converted to a string and inserted.

Feature 2 — Multi-line Strings

Old strings required `\n` escape characters and `+` concatenation for multi-line text:

```
// Old way - ugly
```

```
const old = 'line 1 \n' +  
            'line 2 \n' +  
            'line 3 \n';
```

```
console.log(old);
```

```
// line 1
```

```
// line 2
```

```
// line 3
```

```
// Template literal - just press Enter
```

```
const multiLine = `  
line 1  
line 2  
line 3  
`;  
`;
```

```
console.log(multiLine);  
// (blank line)  
// line 1  
// line 2  
// line 3  
// (blank line)
```

Note: The newline immediately after the opening backtick is included in the string. If you don't want a leading blank line, start your content on the same line as the backtick, or use `.trim()`.

```
// Starting content on the same line avoids the leading newline  
const clean = `line 1  
line 2  
line 3`;
```

Feature 3 — No More Quote Escaping

Old strings broke when the string content contained the same quote character:

```
// Old way - had to escape or switch quote types  
console.log('my name \'\''); // escaping  
console.log("it's a great day"); // switching quote types  
  
// Template literal - backticks don't conflict with ' or "  
console.log(`my name ''`); // no escaping needed  
console.log(`it's a "great" day`); // single and double quotes freely  
used
```

Common Mistake — Nesting Backticks in `${}`

You **can** nest template literals inside `${}`, but the syntax must be correct:

```
const age = 30;
```

```
// WRONG – the backtick inside ${} closes the outer template literal
console.log(` my age ${age `years`} `); // SyntaxError

// CORRECT – use a regular string inside ${}
console.log(` my age ${age + " years"} `); // "my age 30 years"

// CORRECT – nest a template literal properly
console.log(`my age ${`${age} years`} `); // "my age 30 years"
```

Practical Use Cases

Building HTML Strings

Template literals shine when building HTML dynamically:

```
const user = { name: "Omar", age: 30, email: "omar@gmail.com" };

const card = `
  <div class="user-card">
    <h2>${user.name}</h2>
    <p>Age: ${user.age}</p>
    <p>Email: ${user.email}</p>
  </div>
`;

document.body.innerHTML = card;
```

Building URLs

```
const baseUrl = "https://api.example.com";
const userId = 42;
const endpoint = `${baseUrl}/users/${userId}/profile`;
// "https://api.example.com/users/42/profile"
```

Conditional Content

```
const score = 85;
const message = `You scored ${score}/100. ${score >= 60 ? "You passed!" : "You failed."}`;
// "You scored 85/100. You passed!"
```

Multi-line SQL / Queries

```
const query = `
  SELECT name, email
  FROM users
  WHERE age > ${minAge}
  ORDER BY name ASC
`;
```

Logging with Context

```
function divide(a, b) {
  if (b === 0) throw new Error(`Cannot divide ${a} by zero`);
  return a / b;
}
```

Template Literals vs String Concatenation

Feature	Concatenation +	Template Literal
Readability	Hard with many variables	Very readable
Multi-line	Requires <code>\n</code> and <code>+</code>	Just press Enter
Expressions	Only variables work cleanly	Any JS expression
Quote conflicts	Need escaping	No conflicts
Performance	Same	Same

Advanced — Tagged Template Literals

A more advanced feature: you can prefix a template literal with a function name (a "tag") to process it:

```
function highlight(strings, ...values) {
  return strings.reduce((result, str, i) => {
    return result + str + (values[i] ? `<strong>${values[i]}
</strong>` : '');
  }, '');
}

const name = "mona";
const age = 30;

const output = highlight`My name is ${name} and I am ${age} years
old`;
// "My name is <strong>mona</strong> and I am <strong>30</strong>
years old"
```

Tagged templates are used in real-world libraries like `styled-components` (CSS-in-JS), `graphql` (query parsing), and `sql` (safe query building).

Quick Reference

```
// Basic interpolation
`Hello, ${name}!`

// Expression
`Result: ${a + b}`

// Function call
`Upper: ${str.toUpperCase()}`

// Ternary
`${x > 0 ? "positive" : "negative"}`

// Multi-line
`line 1
line 2`
```

```
line 3`
```

```
// Single and double quotes – no escaping  
`it's a "beautiful" day`
```

```
// Nested template literal  
`outer ${`inner ${value}`} outer`
```

Summary

Template Literals (backticks ``) give you:

1. Interpolation → `${expression}` – embed any JS expression
2. Multi-line → just press Enter, no `\n` needed
3. No quote issues → use ' and " freely inside backticks
4. Tagged templates → advanced processing with a tag function

Abdullah Ali

Contact : +201012613453